

EL, LOS, ME, NOS, SE THE LITTLE WORDS

which one, and where it goes:

1. Before a noun — articles the / a — they agree with the noun

	SINGULAR	PLURAL	SINGULAR	PLURAL
masculine	el libro	los libros	un libro	unos libros
feminine	la casa	las casas	una casa	unas casas
	the	the	a	some

el café · **la** música · **los** perros · **las** llaves
a + el → **al** (voy al cine) · de + el → **del** (el coche del profesor)

2. Before the verb — me, te, le, nos, os, les to or for someone — this is the gustar set

me	to me	nos	to us
te	to you	os	to you all
le	to him / her / you (usted)	les	to them

Nos gusta este restaurante.
lit. this restaurant pleases **us** → we like this restaurant
Nos gustan los restaurantes.
the verb agrees with the thing liked, never with you: one thing → gusta, several → gustan
A mis amigos les gusta la música.
naming the person needs both halves: **a** + person, and the pronoun still stays · **les** matches the people, **gusta** matches la música

3. Before the verb — lo, la, los, las the thing itself: it, him, her, them

me	me	nos	us
te	you	os	you all
lo / la	him, it (m.) / her, it (f.)	los / las	them (m. / f.)

¿Ves el libro? — Sí, **lo** veo. = I see it
¿Tienes las llaves? — Sí, **las** tengo. = I have them
it replaces a noun you already said, and it copies that noun's gender and number

4. Before the verb — me, te, se, nos, os, se back on yourself: reflexive verbs

me	myself	nos	ourselves
te	yourself	os	yourselves
se	himself / herself	se	themselves

Me levanto a las siete. = I get (myself) up
Se llama Pierre. = he calls himself Pierre = his name is
Nos acostamos tarde. = we go to bed late

5. The same word, two jobs look at what comes next

los libros

los + **noun** = **the** books · it's an article

los veo

los + **verb** = I see **them** · it's a pronoun

6. Where the little word sits never after the conjugated verb

Me gusta el café. · **Lo** veo. · **Se** llama Ana. — straight before the verb

No **me** gusta. · No **lo** veo. — after no, still before the verb

Quiero ver**lo**. = **Lo** quiero ver. — with an infinitive, either stuck on the end or out in front

Voy a hacer**lo**. = **Lo** voy a hacer. — same with ir a + infinitive

le and **les** are for the person, **lo / la / los / las** for the thing: *le doy el libro* (I give him the book) vs *lo doy* (I give it).
se also stands in for **le / les** before **lo**: *se lo doy* = I give it to him.

Articles & pronouns
A1 — sections 2 and 5 first